



Save humanity in Plague Inc.

Plague Inc. devs are working on a new mode where you need to save humanity from a pandemic. <https://digit.in/apr20-05>



Minecraft graduation

A Japanese school cancelled their graduation ceremony, so the students recreated it in Minecraft. <https://digit.in/apr20-06>

Ig Nobel Prizes

The Ig Nobel prizes are meant to sound similar to “ignoble” and are a satirical awards ceremony where actual nobel prize winners present the awards to scientists whose research have unexpected, bewildering or outrageous results. Here is a selection of the winners.

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Infectivity of bank notes Economics, 2019

One of the vectors of transmission of multi drug resistant microorganisms is that of currency, paper money and coins, which together are the most passed around items in the world. A study published in Antimicrob Resist Infect



Control journal called Money and transmission of bacteria investigated which country's currency is most hospitable to bacteria. Three bacteria were used to study, Staphylococcus aureus, Escherichia coli, and Vancomycin-Resistant Enterococci (VRE). The most infectious currency was the Romanian Leu, where all the bacteria managed to survive even after six hours of drying.

In fact, the VRE managed to stay on the notes even after a whole day of drying. The cleanest note among those studied was the Croatian Luna, which yielded no bacteria after only 3 hours of drying. The Indian Rupee was among the cleaner notes, yielding only VRE after three hours of drying, and no bacteria after 6 hours.

Magnetised Cockroaches Biology, 2019

It has long been believed that birds and some insects use the magnetic field of the Earth to navigate around. Understanding the exact mechanism that allows them to do this can be useful for designing microrobots.

It was also known, at least to the researchers, that cockroaches can rapidly themselves get magnetised when they are exposed to magnetic fields.

An international team of researchers began to study how cockroaches get magnetised, when they stum-

bled upon quite a remarkable discovery. Dead cockroaches were able to retain their magnetic properties for much longer than living cockroaches, when removed from the field.

The researchers further investigated the phenomenon and found that there was a viscous medium that contained magnetic particles in the cockroaches. This viscous medium solidifies after the death of the cockroaches, allowing the dead cockroaches to remain magnetic for longer periods as compared to living cockroaches. This discovery nabbed the Ig Nobel prize in Biology in 2019.

